

I believe that most people in this country and throughout the free world, whether they are young or old and regardless of their profession, education, background, or economic position, should learn to save and invest in common stocks. This book isn't written for the elite, but for the millions of ordinary guys and gals everywhere who want a chance to be better off financially. You are never too old or too young to start investing intelligently.

● **YOU CAN START SMALL**—If you're a typical working person or a beginning investor, you should know that it doesn't take a lot of money to start. You can begin with as little as \$500 to \$1,000 and add to it as you earn and save more money. I began with the purchase of just five shares of Procter & Gamble when I was only 21 and fresh out of school.

Mike Webster is one of our in-house managers who also started small. In fact, Mike sold personal belongings, including his music CD collection, to raise cash for investing. Prior to managing money for the firm, he had a gain of over 1,000% in his personal account in 1999, a very unusual year.

Steve Birch, another of our in-house money managers, started managing money earlier. He took advantage of the roaring bull market of the late 1990s and protected most of his gains by going mainly to cash in the bear market. Between 1998 and 2003, he had gained over 1,300%. Both Mike and Steve have had their rough years, but they've learned from their many mistakes, which we all make, and gone on to achieve significant performance.

You live in a fantastic time of unlimited opportunity, an era of outstanding new ideas, emerging industries, and new frontiers. However, you have to read the rest of this book to learn how to recognize and take advantage of these amazing new situations.

The opportunities are out there for everyone. You are now in a continually changing and, hopefully, improving New America. We lead the world in high technology, the Internet, medical advancements, computer software, military capability, and innovative new entrepreneurial companies. The communist/socialist system and the concept of a